Rebecca L. Martinez

Undergraduate Researcher | Student Assistant
Environmental Studies Program | University of California, Santa Barbara
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Education

B.S. in Environmental Studies, University of California, Santa Barbara — Expected 2027
A.S. in Biology, Allan Hancock College *(With honors)* — Jun 2024
A.A. in Biology, Allan Hancock College *(With honors)* — Dec 2023
A.A. in Mathematics and Science, Allan Hancock College *(With high honors)* — Jun 2021

Awards and Honors

Fall Birnam Wood Veterans Scholarship — $3,000	2026
Fall Birnam Wood Veterans Scholarship — $3,000	2025
Gene & Susan Lucas Undergraduate Research Fund — $500	2025
Crankstart Transfer Scholarship — $5,000	2025
2025 UCSB Edison STEM Conference Research Scholarship — $2000	2025
UCNRS Field Science Fellowship — $5,000 + $1,000 project stipend	2025
Bren Environmental Studies Fellows Program — $600	2025
Gene & Susan Lucas Undergraduate Research Fund — $1,000	2025
Wenger Scholarship, UCSB Environmental Studies — $2,000	2025
UCSB Promise Scholarship — $60,000 total over 2 years	2024
PEO Foundation Scholarship — $1,250	2024
UCSB MESA M-STP Program Scholarship — $500	2024
Capt. G. Allan Hancock Scholarship — $3,500	2024
Allan Hancock College MESA Scholarship — $500	2023
Brander Vineyard Scholarship — $3,000	2023
Brander Vineyard Scholarship — $1,000	2022
Joan Semelsberger-Roth Scholarship — $2,000	2022
Joan Semelsberger-Roth Scholarship — $1,000	2021
Alpha Gamma Sigma Kathleen D. Loly Academic Award — $800	2021
Alpha Gamma Sigma Aquarius Chapter Leadership Award	2021
Joyce Dendo Veteran Scholarship — $500	2021
Virginia B. Martinez Memorial Scholarship — $500	2021

Research Field Experience

Undergraduate Researcher, Soils, Weathering, and Mineral Processes (SWAMP) Lab, UC Santa Barbara — Jan 2025-Present

Geologic Nitrogen Inputs to Semi-Arid Soils with and without Mammalian Bioturbation

Conduct research with Dr. Iris Holzer on rock-derived nitrogen and mammalian bioturbation in semi-arid soils at Sedgwick Reserve and Santa Cruz Island. Collected and prepared soil and rock samples for isotope analysis using a rock saw and shatterbox, maintained project records, and analyzed data using R/RStudio.

Field Trainee, Environmental Studies Program, University of California, Santa Barbara — Spring 2026

Soil Genesis, Morphology, and Classification

Completed techinal field descriptions of soils, including classifications and interpretation. Worked in small and large groups under shifting field conditions. Compared national survey data and maps to field data

Research Assistant, UC Santa Barbara Mar 2025-Present
Soil Carbon Stabilization Study

Assisted with soil-pit excavation, bulk-density sampling, and soil-auger collection at UCNRS Sedgwick Reserve.

Completed USDA soil profile descriptions and followed field-sampling protocols.

Participant, UCSB–Smithsonian Scholars Program Jun 2023-Aug 2023
Completed advanced field methods and data science training at UCNRS Santa Cruz Island Reserve and Smithsonian Tropical Research Institute (STRI), Panama, including RStudio/PositCloud instruction.

Professional Experience

Seasonal Park Aide, California State Parks, Channel Islands District Sep 2026-Present
Staff the entrance station, collect day-use fees, register campers, issue passes, and answer visitor questions at Refugio and El Capitan State Beaches.

Operate cash-register and computer systems, explain park rules, and assist with general cleaning and park operations.

Student Assistant, UCSB Office of Education Partnerships Oct 2024–June 2026
Collect data, maintain field sites, repair equipment, updated protocols, and supported project logistics to improve research operations.

Chumash Casino Resort, Santa Ynez, CA Jun 2006–May 2025
Slot Attendant; assisted guests and resolved service and slot-equipment issues in a busy casino environment. 2012-May 2025

Floor Operations Supervisor; supervised daily floor operations, coordinated staffing, and addressed guest and equipment issues while following casino procedures. 2007-2012

Security Officer; responded to safety concerns and supported a safe environment for guests and employees. Jun 2006–2007

Bulk Fuel Specialist (MOS 1391), United States Marine Corps Reserve Jul 2005-Aug 2010

Teaching and Mentorship

Teaching Assistant, UCSB MESA Successful Transition Program (M-STP) Sep 2025-Sep 2025
Supported a 3-week virtual chemistry workshop for incoming and transfer STEM students. Assisted with Zoom lectures, evaluated assignments, and mentored students to support their transition to UCSB.

Discussion Leader, UCSB–Smithsonian ERES Program Jun-Sep 2025
Assisted udergraduate instruction of RStudio/PositCloud for data manipulation and visualization, mentored students during field workshops at Santa Cruz Island Reserve; trained students on camera traps, Audiomoths, and GPS.

Data Science Intern, Smithsonian Data Science Lab Jun-Sep 2024
Taught R/RStudio and developed instructional resources to help undergraduate students work with data and research projects.

Teaching Assistant, Allan Hancock College Human Anatomy Open Lab Aug 2023–Jun 2024
Facilitated Friday lab sessions, including setup and breakdown; developed visual study guides, led office hours, and supported human cadaver lab activities.

Tutor, Academic Resource Center & STEM Center, Allan Hancock College Aug 2019–Jun 2024

One-on-one, drop-in, and group sessions. Subjects tutored: anatomy, algebra, botany, introductory biology, calculus 1 & 2, cellular biology, introductory & general chemistry, microbiology, and physiology.

Lead Tutor; trained new tutors, led workshops on study skills and time management, and supported onboarding of staff and faculty. Aug 2020– Jun 2024

Embedded Tutor; Hosted review sessions and office hours, helped with grading, and developed study materials for life and physical science courses Jan 2020– Jun 2024

Leadership and Service

Student Representative, UC Systemwide Surveys Student Advisory Group Sep 2025–Present
Gained insight into the full survey process, collaborated on strategies to increase student participation,and provided feedback on survey initiatives

Outreach Volunteer, UCSB Veteran Support Center Jan 2024–Present
Organized networking events to connect veteran students and women veterans within UCSB's communities.

Science Outreach Volunteer, Allan Hancock College Life & Physical Sciences Department Jan 2022–Jun 2024
Helped design and facilitate hands-on science activities for local K–12 students; created educational materials and coordinated event logistics.

Student Representative, Allan Hancock College Aug 2021–Jun 2023
Served as a student representative for faculty and staff hiring committees and Title V Committee to advocate for student needs.

Permanent Member, Alpha Gamma Sigma Aquarius Honor Society, Allan Hancock College Aug 2019–Present

Vice President; Organized meetings, managed member eligibility and service records, and developed an online system to track service points. Jan 2020–Jun 2021

Community Service Chair; Led service projects and fundraisers, organized initiatives including coat and sock drives, book and toy drives, and community clean-up events Aug 2022–Jun 2023

Key Volunteer, Santa Barbara County Toys for Tots Nov 2018–Present
Coordinated donation efforts and distributed toys to children during holiday seasons.

United States Marine Corps Jun 2005–Oct 2010
Developed strong discipline, adaptability, and problem-solving under high-pressure conditions.

Presentations

Geologic Nitrogen Inputs to Semi-Arid Soils with and without Mammalian Bioturbation, American Geophysical Union (AGU) 2025 New Orleans, LA. Dec 2025

Learning from the Ground Up: Mammalian Bioturbators, Soil, & Undergraduate Education, UCSB Environmental Studies 55th Anniversary, Santa Barbara, CA. Apr 2025

Guest Speaker, Allan Hancock Foundation Honors Gala, Santa Maria, CA May 2024

Comparison of Species Richness & Functional Richness Between Barro Colorado Island and Pipeline Road in Panama, Cal Poly Summer Internship Research Symposium, San Luis Obispo, CA. Aug 2023

Comparison of Species Richness & Functional Richness Between Barro Colorado Island and Pipeline Road in Panama, UCSB Fall Undergraduate Research Showcase, Santa Barbara, CA. Nov 2023

Programs and Affiliations

Bren–Environmental Studies Fellows Program 2025–2026
Tau Sigma National Honor Society 2025–Present

American Geophysical Union (AGU)	2025–Present
UCSB Promise Scholars	2024–Present
UCSB Letters & Science Honors Program	2024–Present
UCSB Student Veterans Association (SVA)	2024–Present
PEO Foundation	2024–2025
UCSB–Smithsonian Scholars Program	2023–2024
Association of Colleges for Tutoring & Learning Assistance (ACTLA)	2020–Present
Alpha Gamma Sigma Honor Society	2019–Present
Lompoc Veteran Advisory Committee (LVAC)	2018–Present

Last updated: October 30, 2026

`https://rebeccalmartinez.github.io/personal_website/`